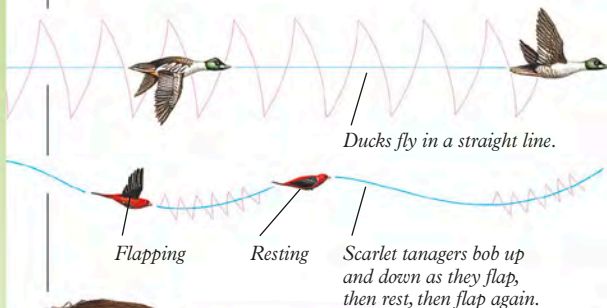


FEATHERS AND FLYING

Feathers are made of *keratin*, like your hair and nails!

Three types of animals can fly—birds, bats, and insects. Birds are excellent fliers thanks to their coats of feathers. Long, light feathers or small, soft feathers cover almost every part of a bird's body. Usually, only a bird's beak, eyes, legs, and feet are bare. Feathers do much more than cover a bird's naked body: they keep birds warm and dry, and enable them to stay up in the air.



Ducks fly in a straight line.

Flapping

Resting

Scarlet tanagers bob up and down as they flap, then rest, then flap again.

Flight patterns

Flying can be hard work. Not all birds flap their wings all the time. Some birds save energy by resting between short bursts of flapping.

Wind power

If you blow hard across the top of a piece of paper, the air on top moves faster than the air underneath. This

difference in air speed creates lift and the paper rises. In a similar way, the air moving over the top of a

bird's wing moves faster than the air going underneath it. This lifts the bird up in the sky.

